

Example Peer Recovery Services, Inc.

Roadmap, Training Matrix and Survey Preparation

What to do, in what order, and how to rehearse for the survey

DRAFT - the CARF section map behind this document has NOT been checked against the purchased manual. Set manual_verified: true before use.

Target survey: 2027-06
Generated 2026-09-06

The 12-Month Roadmap to Survey

The single most important rule: CARF wants to see that you have been *doing* this, not that you wrote it last week. Most manuals require the program to have been in operation and generating records for a minimum period before survey, and expect to see data trends and a completed annual analysis. Confirm the exact minimum in your purchased manual and in the CARF Survey Application, then count backwards from there. Everything below assumes a 12-month runway.

MONTH 12 — 11 (Foundation)

#	Task	Owner	Done
1	Buy the current CARF Behavioral Health Standards Manual from carf.org. You cannot do this properly without it.	Chief Executive Officer	
2	Verify the section map in this skill against your purchased manual and set `manual_verified: true`	Chief Executive Officer	
3	Decide which PROGRAM you are applying for (see the naming trap in SKILL.md)	Chief Executive Officer	
4	Create a CARF customer account; review the Survey Application	Chief Executive Officer	
5	Name your leadership roles: QI Coordinator, Safety Officer, Privacy Officer, Compliance Officer	Chief Executive Officer	
6	Set up the Evidence Binder (physical or digital) with a tab per standard area	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
7	Adopt the Policy and Procedure Manual; governing body approves it	Board of Directors	
8	Start the Grievance Log, Incident Log, and Corrective Action Tracker — even if empty	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	

MONTH 11 — 9 (Build the systems)

#	Task	Owner	Done
9	Write the Program Description; confirm it matches what actually happens	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
10	Write the Staffing Plan with the caseload cap and its rationale	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
11	Complete the Performance Measurement Plan; set targets; START COLLECTING DATA NOW	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
12	Audit every personnel file against the Personnel File Checklist; fix gaps	Chief Executive Officer	
13	Deliver full orientation training to all staff; document it	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
14	Complete competency assessments including direct observation	[FILL IN: Supervisor of the peer workforce]	
15	Start monthly supervision notes; twice monthly for anyone under 90 days	[FILL IN: Supervisor of the peer workforce]	
16	Write the Health and Safety Plan; begin the quarterly drill cycle	[FILL IN: Safety Officer]	
17	Complete the first safety inspection	[FILL IN: Safety Officer]	
18	Write the Risk Management Plan and Risk Register; review insurance	Chief Executive Officer	
19	Write the Technology and System Plan; run a backup restore test	Chief Executive Officer	
20	Write the Accessibility Plan from a real walk-through	Chief Executive Officer	
21	Convert all records to the new plan, note, and crisis plan formats	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	

MONTH 9 — 6 (Run it and generate evidence)

#	Task	Owner	Done
22	First quarterly Quality Record Review; open the Corrective Action Tracker	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
23	First Quarterly Performance Dashboard	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
24	Quarterly drills on every shift; log and critique them	[FILL IN: Safety Officer]	
25	Quarterly safety inspection	[FILL IN: Safety Officer]	
26	Quarterly incident analysis — write the conclusion even if "no trend"	[FILL IN: Safety Officer]	
27	Quarterly grievance trend review	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
28	Governing body meets, reviews performance, and it is in the minutes	Board of Directors	
29	Send the Survey Application to CARF (12+ months before you want the survey; check current lead time)	Chief Executive Officer	
30	Write the Strategic Plan from a documented environmental scan	Chief Executive Officer	

MONTH 6 — 3 (Prove the cycle turned)

#	Task	Owner	Done
31	Run the annual satisfaction surveys — persons served AND other stakeholders	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
32	Write the Input Analysis Report; take at least one action from it	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	

#	Task	Owner	Done
33	Publish the "You said, we did" summary to persons served and staff	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
34	Second and third quarterly record reviews; verify prior corrections closed	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
35	Annual rights review — were rights actually honored?	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
36	Complete at least one PI Project Charter with before and after data	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
37	Annual performance appraisals for every employee	Chief Executive Officer	
38	Complete the Self-Study / conformance checklist honestly; list every gap	Chief Executive Officer	
39	Fix every gap the self-study found; track it on the Corrective Action Tracker	All	

MONTH 3 — 1 (Prove it and rehearse)

#	Task	Owner	Done
40	Write the Annual Performance Analysis Report — the single most-checked document	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
41	Present it to leadership and the governing body; get it in the minutes	Chief Executive Officer	
42	Distribute results to staff, persons served, and stakeholders; document distribution	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
43	Review and re-date every plan: strategic, risk, safety, technology, accessibility, cultural, workforce, compliance	Chief Executive Officer	
44	Complete the Evidence Binder; every tab has its documents	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
45	Run a full MOCK SURVEY using the Mock Survey Interview Guide	Consultant / Chief Executive Officer	
46	Interview-prep every staff member; they must be able to answer in their own words	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
47	Ask 3-5 persons served if they will speak with the surveyor; prepare, never coach	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
48	Pull 5 records at random and audit them as a surveyor would	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
49	Fix everything the mock survey found	All	

MONTH 1 — SURVEY WEEK

#	Task	Owner	Done
50	Confirm survey dates, logistics, room, and internet for the surveyor	Chief Executive Officer	
51	Have the Evidence Binder and a laptop with the electronic health record access in the survey room	[FILL IN: Quality Improvement Coordinator]	
52	Confirm which staff and persons served are available for interview each day	[FILL IN: Program Director name]	
53	Brief everyone: tell the truth, say "I don't know, let me find out," never guess	Chief Executive Officer	
54	Attend the exit conference; write down every recommendation verbatim	Chief Executive Officer	

AFTER THE SURVEY

#	Task	Owner	Done
55	Read the survey report when it arrives	Chief Executive Officer	
56	Submit the Quality Improvement Plan by CARF's deadline — usually within 90 days of the report; confirm your own deadline	Chief Executive Officer	
57	Diarize the Annual Conformance to Quality Report each year of the accreditation term	Chief Executive Officer	
58	Keep the cycle running — the next survey looks at the years in between	All	

Required Training Matrix

Attendance is not competency. For anything marked "Competency required," you must also document that the person can actually do it — see the Competency Assessment form.

#	Training	Peer Support Specialist	Supervisor	Program Director	Admin	Board	Frequency	Competency required
1	Mission, program description, what peer support is and is not	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation	Yes
2	Code of ethics	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	No
3	Corporate compliance; fraud, waste, abuse	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	No
4	Non-retaliation and reporting concerns	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	No
5	Rights of persons served	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	Yes
6	Grievance process	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	Yes
7	Confidentiality, HIPAA	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	Yes
8	Informed consent	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
9	Documentation standards and timeframes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
10	Person-centered planning	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
11	Emergency procedures	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
12	Critical incident reporting	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
13	Abuse, neglect, exploitation — mandated reporting	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
14	Infection control / standard precautions	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	No
15	First aid and CPR	Yes	Yes	Yes	Optional	No	Per certification	Yes
16	Naloxone	Yes	Yes	Yes	Optional	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
17	Cultural competency and humility	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	No
18	Recovery pathway neutrality	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	Yes
19	Trauma-informed care	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
20	De-escalation / nonviolent practices	Yes	Yes	Yes	Optional	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
21	Crisis response and warm hand-off	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
22	Boundaries and dual relationships	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
23	Self-disclosure	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
24	Social media, texting, devices	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + annual	No
25	Information security	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Orientation + annual	No
26	Medication limits for peer staff	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
27	Community, home visit, lone-worker safety	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
28	Driver safety and transportation policy	If driving	If driving	If driving	If driving	No	Orientation + annual	Yes
29	Telehealth / ICT delivery	If used	If used	If used	No	No	Before first use + annual	Yes
30	the electronic health record	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Orientation + on change	Yes
31	Supervision skills	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Within 90 days of appointment	Yes
32	Quality improvement basics	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Annual	No
33	Board duties and governance	No	No	No	No	Yes	At appointment + annual	No
34	Credential continuing education	Yes	Yes	As required	No	No	Per credential	n/a

Documentation required for every training: topic, date, duration, trainer name AND qualification, curriculum or outline, and the signature of each attendee. A sign-in sheet with no trainer qualification is a common finding.

Mock Survey Interview Guide

Run this as a real rehearsal at least 60 days before the survey. Have someone who does not work in the program ask the questions. Write down the actual answers. Any answer that is a shrug, a guess, or "I'd have to ask the director" is a gap — fix it with training, not with a script.

Tell every person the three rules before the survey:

1. Tell the truth. A surveyor can tell when you are performing.
2. "I don't know, but I know where to find it" is a good answer. Guessing is not.
3. Never say what you think they want to hear. Say what actually happens.

A. Interview with the Chief Executive Officer / leadership

1. Walk me through your organizational chart. Who is accountable for quality?
2. What does your strategic plan say, and what data did it come from?
3. When did the governing body last review performance? Show me the minutes.
4. What are your top three risks and what are you doing about each?
5. Show me your budget and the assumptions behind it. Who reconciles the bank statement?
6. What did last year's performance analysis tell you, and what changed because of it?
7. How do you know your staff are competent, not just trained?
8. Tell me about a complaint you received and what happened.
9. What is your biggest weakness as an organization right now?

B. Interview with the [FILL IN: Program Director name]

1. Describe the program. Who is it for and what do you actually do?
2. How long from referral to first contact? How do you know?
3. What happens to someone you cannot serve?
4. What is your caseload cap and how did you decide on it?
5. Show me how a person-centered plan gets made. Who writes the goals?
6. How do you know notes are done on time?
7. What happens after a critical incident?
8. How do you handle it when a peer specialist knows a participant from their own recovery community?
9. What happens when someone just stops showing up?

C. Interview with Peer Support Specialists (the most important interview)

1. What is peer support? What is it not?
2. What makes you qualified for this job?
3. How often do you get supervision, and what do you talk about?
4. Give me an example of when you shared your own story. Why did you share it?
5. What would you do if a participant asked you something you are not qualified to answer?
6. What do you do if someone tells you they stopped taking their medication?
7. You are at a home visit and you feel unsafe. Exactly what do you do?
8. Someone escalates in your car. What do you do?
9. You see a participant at your own recovery meeting. What now?
10. A participant sends you a friend request. What do you do?
11. Where are the emergency procedures? What do you do in a fire here?
12. Who do you report a suspected abuse situation to, and how fast?
13. How do you know what a participant's goal is?
14. How do you take care of yourself in this job? Does the agency help?
15. If you had a concern about the agency, who would you tell? What if it was about your boss?

D. Interview with persons served

Never coach answers. Ask people who will speak freely, including people who have complained.

1. How did you get connected here?
2. How long did you wait?
3. Did someone explain your rights? Do you have a copy?
4. If you had a complaint, what would you do? Who would you call?
5. Would anything bad happen to you if you complained?
6. Whose goals are on your plan? Who picked them?
7. Can you show me your plan? Are those your words?
8. Can you say no to something here?
9. Has anyone pressured you about medication or about how you do your recovery?
10. Where do you meet your peer specialist?
11. What has changed in your life since you started?
12. Is there anything you needed that they could not help with?
13. Do you know what happens when services end?

E. Interview with the Supervisor

1. How do you assess competency? Have you ever watched someone deliver service?
2. How often do you supervise, and what is documented?
3. How do you supervise self-disclosure?
4. What do you do when a boundary problem comes up?
5. What have you found in record reviews and what did you do about it?
6. What do you do when a staff member is struggling with their own recovery?

F. Document requests to expect

Have these physically ready in the Evidence Binder before day one.

- Organizational chart, leadership job descriptions, leadership minutes (12 months)
- Governing body minutes (12 months), conflict of interest disclosures, board self-assessment, CEO evaluation
- Strategic plan + environmental scan + review minutes
- Input analysis report + surveys + "you said, we did" summary + proof of distribution
- Budget + assumptions + 12 months budget-to-actual + bank reconciliations + external financial review
- Risk management plan + risk register + insurance declarations
- Health and safety plan + 4 quarters of inspections + 12 months of drill logs (all shifts, one unannounced) + incident log + quarterly incident analyses
- 3-5 complete personnel files
- Technology plan + BAAs + backup restore test + access log + separation checklist
- Rights statement (posted), grievance procedure (posted), grievance log, one complete grievance file, annual rights review
- Accessibility plan (all 8 areas) + barrier survey + accommodation log + this year's progress
- Performance measurement plan + measure definition sheets + 4 quarterly dashboards
- Annual performance analysis report + PI project charters + proof of distribution
- Program description, staffing plan, community resource directory
- Referral log, waitlist log, referral-out log
- 5-8 records of persons served, open and closed
- 4 quarters of record reviews + corrective action tracker + summary reports
- Records retention schedule + certificates of destruction

G. The five questions that most often expose a gap

1. **"Show me the data."** Policies are easy. Four quarters of real data is not.
2. **"What did you do about it?"** Finding a problem is half. Closing it is the standard.
3. **"How did the people you serve find out?"** Distribution of results is the most-missed requirement in Section 1.M.

4. **"Show me the drill on the evening shift."** Drills usually cover one shift only.

5. **"Read me a goal in the person's own words."** Goals written by staff, in staff language, are the most common Section 2.C finding.

Evidence Binder Index

One tab per standard area. On survey day the surveyor names an area; you hand them that tab. Build this as you go, not in the last month.

Tab 1.A — Leadership

Leadership is identified, accountable, and ethical. There is a written code of ethics, a way to raise concerns without retaliation, a corporate compliance program, and evidence that leadership considers cultural competency and the needs of the people served when making decisions.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1A-01 Leadership Structure and Accountability	Policy		
1A-02 Code of Ethics	Policy		
1A-03 Corporate Compliance Program	Policy		
1A-04 Cultural Competency and Health Equity	Policy		
1A-05 Non-Retaliation and Reporting of Concerns	Policy		
1A-06 Leadership Succession and Continuity	Policy		
1A-07 Document Control, Version Management and Implementation	Policy		
Corporate Compliance Plan	Plan		
Cultural Competency and Diversity Plan	Plan		
Code of Ethics Attestation	Completed form / evidence		
Conflict of Interest Disclosure	Completed form / evidence		
Master Document Register	Completed form / evidence		
Document Rollout and Implementation Record	Completed form / evidence		
Implementation Tracer Record	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me your org chart and who is accountable for what. (2) Show me the signed code of ethics for every staff member. (3) Tell me about a time someone raised an ethical concern and what happened. (4) How does leadership know what the community you serve needs? (5) Show me one policy traced end to end: approved, published, staff trained, competency observed, and then checked in real practice. (6) How do you know staff are working from the current version and not last year's?

Tab 1.B — Governance (Optional)

If the organization has a governing board, the board has written duties, meets, keeps minutes, evaluates the CEO, evaluates itself, and manages conflicts of interest. A sole-owner agency documents who performs these governance functions instead.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1B-01 Governance	Policy		
Governing Body Meeting Minutes	Completed form / evidence		
Governing Body Self-Assessment	Completed form / evidence		
Annual Evaluation of the Chief Executive Officer	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) May I see twelve months of board minutes? (2) When did the board last evaluate the CEO? (3) How does the board assess its own performance?

Tab 1.C — Strategic Planning

A written strategic plan exists that was built from real inputs: what is happening in the environment, what stakeholders expect, financial reality, technology, workforce, and risk. It is reviewed at least annually and the review is documented.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1C-01 Strategic Integrated Planning	Policy		
Strategic Plan	Plan		
Environmental Scan Worksheet	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me the strategic plan and the minutes where it was reviewed. (2) What data went into it? (3) What changed as a result?

Tab 1.D — Input from Persons Served and Other Stakeholders

The organization systematically collects input from the people it serves and from other stakeholders (families, referral sources, payers, staff, community partners), analyzes it at least annually, acts on it, and reports the results back to those stakeholders.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1D-01 Input from Persons Served and Other Stakeholders	Policy		
Satisfaction Survey — Persons Served	Completed form / evidence		
Satisfaction Survey — Other Stakeholders	Completed form / evidence		
Annual Input Analysis Report	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me last year's satisfaction results. (2) What did you change because of them? (3) How did you tell the people served what changed?

Tab 1.E — Legal Requirements

The organization knows and follows the laws, regulations, licensure and contract obligations that apply to it, and there is a written process for staying current and for reviewing contracts before signing.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1E-01 Legal and Regulatory Compliance	Policy		
Regulatory Obligations Register	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What licenses and contracts are you operating under? (2) Who tracks renewal dates? (3) Show me the current license certificate.

Tab 1.F — Financial Planning and Management

There is an annual budget built on reasonable assumptions, actual results are compared to budget regularly, there are written internal controls (separation of duties, approval limits), fees are documented, and an external financial review is obtained.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1F-01 Financial Planning and Budgeting	Policy		
1F-02 Internal Financial Controls, Fees, and Billing Integrity	Policy		
Financial Plan and Budget Narrative	Plan		
Monthly Budget-to-Actual Variance Review	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me the budget and the monthly comparison to actual. (2) Who signs checks and who reconciles the bank statement? (3) Show me the most recent external review or audit.

Tab 1.G — Risk Management

There is a written risk management plan that names the organization's actual risks (financial, clinical, reputational, staffing, technology, community-based service delivery), what is being done about each, what insurance is carried, and when it was last reviewed.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1G-01 Risk Management	Policy		
Risk Management Plan	Plan		
Risk Register	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What are your top risks and what are you doing about them? (2) Show me your insurance declarations page. (3) When was the plan last reviewed and by whom?

Tab 1.H — Health and Safety

Written emergency procedures for every foreseeable emergency; drills that are actually run, documented, and critiqued; documented safety inspections; critical incident reporting and analysis; infection control; first aid and emergency training; and safety procedures for staff working alone in the community or in someone's home.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1H-01 Health and Safety Management	Policy		
1H-02 Emergency Procedures and Drills	Policy		
1H-03 Critical Incident Reporting and Analysis	Policy		

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1H-04 Infection Prevention and Control	Policy		
1H-05 Community, Home Visit, and Lone Worker Safety	Policy		
Health and Safety Plan	Plan		
Business Continuity and Emergency Operations Plan	Plan		
Site Safety Inspection Checklist	Completed form / evidence		
Emergency Drill Log	Completed form / evidence		
Critical Incident Report	Completed form / evidence		
Quarterly Incident Analysis Summary	Completed form / evidence		
Community and Home Visit Safety Plan	Completed form / evidence		
Vehicle Inspection Log	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me a year of drill records for every shift and every emergency type. (2) Walk me through what happens if a peer specialist feels unsafe at a home visit. (3) Show me your incident log and the analysis of trends.

Tab 1.I — Workforce Development and Management

Written job descriptions; verification of credentials before hire (including the state peer credential); background checks; documented orientation; competency-based training with documented competency, not just attendance; regular documented supervision; annual performance appraisal; and a documented look at workforce needs and succession.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1I-01 Recruitment, Verification, and Hiring	Policy		
1I-02 Orientation and Training	Policy		
1I-03 Competency Assessment	Policy		
1I-04 Supervision	Policy		
1I-05 Performance Appraisal, Workforce Planning, and Personnel Records	Policy		
Workforce Development and Succession Plan	Plan		
Job Description — Peer Support Specialist	Completed form / evidence		
Job Description — Peer Supervisor	Completed form / evidence		
Job Description — Program Director	Completed form / evidence		
New Personnel Orientation Checklist	Completed form / evidence		
Competency Assessment — Peer Support Specialist	Completed form / evidence		
Supervision Note	Completed form / evidence		
Annual Performance Appraisal	Completed form / evidence		
Credential and Background Verification Log	Completed form / evidence		
Individual Training Log	Completed form / evidence		
Personnel File Checklist	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Pull three personnel files. Show me credential verification, orientation, competency, supervision, and the last appraisal in each. (2) How do you know a new peer specialist is competent, not just trained? (3) Show me the supervision notes for the last six months.

Tab 1.J — Rights of Persons Served

Rights are written, given to and explained to every person served in a way they can understand, and posted. There is a written grievance/complaint process with timeframes and an appeal, a grievance log, informed consent, and confidentiality protections. Rights are reviewed annually for whether they were actually honored.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1J-01 Rights of the Persons Served	Policy		
1J-02 Grievances, Complaints, and Appeals	Policy		
1J-03 Confidentiality and Release of Information	Policy		
1J-04 Informed Consent for Services	Policy		
Your Rights — Handout for Persons Served	Completed form / evidence		
Complaint / Grievance Form	Completed form / evidence		
Grievance and Complaint Log	Completed form / evidence		
Consent for Services	Completed form / evidence		
Authorization to Release Information	Completed form / evidence		

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
Acknowledgment of Receipt — Notice of Privacy Practices	Completed form / evidence		
Annual Review — Were Rights Actually Honored?	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Ask a person served: do you know how to file a complaint? (2) Show me the grievance log and what happened with each one. (3) Show me signed consents in three records.

Tab 1.K — Accessibility

A written accessibility plan that identifies real barriers in eight areas - architectural, environmental, attitudinal, financial, employment, communication, transportation, and digital/technology - names an action and a responsible person for each, and is reviewed annually with progress documented.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1K-01 Accessibility	Policy		
Accessibility Plan	Plan		
Accessibility Barrier Survey	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me your accessibility plan and this year's progress. (2) What barrier did you remove in the last twelve months? (3) How would a person who is deaf access your service?

Tab 1.L — Performance Measurement and Management

The organization decides in writing what it will measure, why, how, how often, and what the target is - covering both business function and service delivery, and covering effectiveness, efficiency, service access, and satisfaction. Data is actually collected and reported on schedule.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1L-01 Performance Measurement and Management	Policy		
Performance Measurement and Management Plan	Plan		
Measure Definition Sheet	Completed form / evidence		
Quarterly Performance Dashboard	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What exactly do you measure and what is your target? (2) Show me the data for the last four quarters. (3) How do you define a successful outcome for a person in peer support?

Tab 1.M — Performance Improvement

The measured data is analyzed at least annually in a written performance analysis, conclusions are drawn, improvement actions are taken and tracked, and the results are shared with staff, persons served, and other stakeholders in a format they can understand.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
1M-01 Performance Improvement	Policy		
Performance Improvement Plan and Annual Analysis Template	Plan		
Annual Performance Analysis Report — Cover and Sign-Off	Completed form / evidence		
Performance Improvement Project Charter	Completed form / evidence		
"You Said, We Did" — Results Summary for Persons Served and Stakeholders	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me last year's written performance analysis. (2) Name one improvement project and show me the before and after numbers. (3) How did the people you serve find out about these results?

Tab 2.A — Program/Service Structure

A written program description that says who the program serves, what it does, where and when, who delivers it and with what qualifications, and how it connects people to community resources. Services are person-centered and recovery-oriented, and staffing is sufficient for the people served.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2A-01 Program Description and Service Structure	Policy		
2A-02 Community Resources and Coordination of Care	Policy		

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
Program Description	Completed form / evidence		
Community Resource Directory	Completed form / evidence		
Staffing Plan	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me the written program description. (2) Does what I am seeing on site match what this says? (3) How many people can one peer specialist carry, and how did you decide that?

Tab 2.B — Screening and Access to Services

Written eligibility criteria, a documented screening process with timeframes, what happens when someone is not eligible or must wait, and a documented orientation for every person entering the program that covers rights, grievance, confidentiality, fees, and what to expect.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2B-01 Screening, Eligibility, and Access to Services	Policy		
2B-02 Orientation of the Person Served	Policy		
Screening and Referral Form	Completed form / evidence		
Waiting List Log	Completed form / evidence		
Orientation of the Person Served	Completed form / evidence		
Referral-Out Log (People We Could Not Serve)	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) How long between the referral and the first contact? Prove it. (2) Show me a signed orientation checklist in a record. (3) What do you do when someone does not meet criteria?

Tab 2.C — Person-Centered Planning

Each person has an individualized plan built with them, in their own words, reflecting their strengths, needs, abilities and preferences, with goals and measurable objectives, the specific services and who provides them, target dates, and the person's signature. The plan is reviewed on a stated schedule and updated when things change.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2C-01 Person-Centered Planning	Policy		
2C-02 Plan Review and Documentation of Services	Policy		
Person-Centered Plan	Completed form / evidence		
Person-Centered Plan Review	Completed form / evidence		
My Wellness and Recovery Plan	Completed form / evidence		
Peer Support Progress Note	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Read me a goal in the person's own words. (2) Show me where the person signed and dated the plan. (3) Show me the review that was due last month. (4) Does this progress note connect to a goal on this plan?

Tab 2.D — Transition/Discharge

Transition planning begins at admission, not at the end. There is a written transition/discharge summary for every person who leaves, including unplanned exits, and a documented attempt at follow-up after discharge with the results recorded and analyzed.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2D-01 Transition Planning	Policy		
2D-02 Discharge Summary and Follow-Up	Policy		
Transition / Discharge Summary	Completed form / evidence		
Post-Discharge Follow-Up Contact Log	Completed form / evidence		
Unplanned Exit Review	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me discharge summaries for the last five people who left, including the ones who just stopped coming. (2) What does your follow-up data tell you?

Tab 2.E — Medication Use

If the program does not prescribe, dispense, administer, or store medication, that must be stated in writing, and staff must know their limits and what to do about medication questions and adverse reactions. If it does any of those things, a full medication management policy set is required.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2E-01 Medication	Policy		
Medication — What Your Peer Specialist Can and Cannot Do	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Do you touch medication in any way? (2) Ask a peer specialist: what do you do if someone tells you they stopped their medication?

Tab 2.F — Promoting Nonviolent Practices

A written commitment to nonviolent practice: de-escalation training for staff, what is prohibited, what to do in a behavioral crisis, when to call for help, and a debriefing with the person served and staff after any crisis event.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2F-01 Nonviolent Practices	Policy		
2F-02 Crisis Response and Debriefing	Policy		
Crisis Debriefing Form	Completed form / evidence		
De-escalation and Nonviolent Practices Training Log	Completed form / evidence		
My Personal Safety and Crisis Plan	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What restraint or seclusion do you use? (correct answer for most peer programs: none, and it is prohibited in writing) (2) Ask staff: what do you do if someone escalates in the car? (3) Show me a debriefing after your last crisis event.

Tab 2.G — Records of the Persons Served

A written list of what belongs in a record, who may write in it, how quickly entries must be made, how corrections are made, how records are secured, how long they are kept, and how they are destroyed. Entries are legible, dated, and signed with credential.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2G-01 Content and Maintenance of the Record of the Person Served	Policy		
2G-02 Records Retention, Access, and Destruction	Policy		
Record Content Checklist	Completed form / evidence		
Records Retention Schedule	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What is your documentation timeframe and can you prove notes meet it? (2) Where are paper records kept and who has the key? (3) Show me how a correction is made.

Tab 2.H — Quality Records Management

Records are reviewed on a written schedule using a written tool, by someone qualified, looking at whether documentation supports the service and the plan. Results are aggregated, trends identified, and corrective action tracked to closure.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2H-01 Quality Record Review	Policy		
Quality Record Review Tool	Completed form / evidence		
Quarterly Record Review Summary Report	Completed form / evidence		
Corrective Action Tracker	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me your last four quarterly record reviews. (2) What did you find and what did you do about it? (3) Show me that the correction actually happened.

Tab 2.I — Service Delivery Using Information and Communication Technologies

Where any part of the service is delivered by video, phone or other technology, it meets the same standards as in-person service: informed consent specific to the technology, identity and location verified at each contact, an emergency plan for the person's actual location, an approved platform under a business associate agreement, staff trained and assessed as competent in delivering peer support remotely, and documentation that records the modality and both parties' locations.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
2I-01 Information and Communication Technology in Service Delivery (Telehealth)	Policy		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Do you deliver any part of this service by video or phone? (2) Show me a technology-specific consent. (3) Where is the person when you meet by video, and how do you know? (4) If someone was in crisis on a video call, how would you get help to them?

Tab 3.C — Community Integration

The program helps people participate in community life as they choose - housing, work, education, benefits, relationships, transportation, recreation, health care, and civic life. It is built on the person's own goals, uses natural supports and real community settings rather than segregated ones, and measures actual community participation, not just service contacts.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
3C-01 Community Integration Program Philosophy and Scope	Policy		
3C-02 Choice, Self-Determination, and Dignity of Risk	Policy		
3C-03 Natural Supports and Community Connection	Policy		
3C-04 Transportation and Community Outings	Policy		
3C-05 Advocacy, Benefits, and Removing Barriers	Policy		
Community Integration Goal Worksheet	Completed form / evidence		
Natural Supports Map	Completed form / evidence		
Community Resource Directory	Completed form / evidence		
Benefits and Entitlements Checklist	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) Show me a person who moved into their own housing, got a job, or joined something in the community because of you. (2) How do you measure community participation? (3) Ask a person served: what do you want that we are helping you get?

Tab 3.PEER — Peer Workforce Requirements (this skill's own grouping - NOT a CARF area)

Peer support is a WORKFORCE and a service model, not a separate CARF program section. Its requirements are enforced through 1.I (credential, competency, supervision), 2.A (program description and staffing), 2.C (person-centered planning done WITH the person), and the Section 3 program. This area exists so nothing peer-specific falls between the cracks: lived experience as a job qualification, the state peer credential, self-disclosure boundaries, mutuality, dual-relationship management in small recovery communities, peer staff wellness, and career ladder. CONFIRMED against the 2026 table of contents: there is no Peer Support program in Sections 3 or 4, and CARF's own 2026 Behavioral Health Program Descriptions mention peer support once in 23 pages, as staffing for a crisis contact center. The nearest real CARF home for this material is the CONSUMER-RUN specialty designation at 5.D, page 318 - check whether the agency qualifies.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
3P-01 The Peer Support Service Model	Policy		
3P-02 Self-Disclosure	Policy		
3P-03 Boundaries and Dual Relationships	Policy		
3P-04 Peer Workforce Wellness	Policy		
3P-05 Peer Specialist Credential, Scope, and Career Ladder	Policy		
Job Description — Peer Support Specialist	Completed form / evidence		
Competency Assessment — Peer Support Specialist	Completed form / evidence		
Self-Disclosure Supervision Worksheet	Completed form / evidence		
Dual Relationship Disclosure and Management Plan	Completed form / evidence		
My Peer Wellness Plan (Staff)	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What makes someone qualified to be a peer specialist here? (2) How do you supervise self-disclosure? (3) What happens when a peer specialist knows a participant from their own recovery community? (4) How do you protect the wellness of staff in recovery?

Tab X.TECH — Technology and Information Security - CARF home NOT YET CONFIRMED

The 2026 Section 1 has NO Technology area - it runs A Leadership to M Performance Improvement with no technology heading. These three policies (technology and system planning, information security, and social media / devices / electronic communication) are good practice and most payers require them, but their home in the manual is unconfirmed. Service delivery BY technology is a different thing and lives at 2.I. FIND THEIR HOME IN APPENDIX A (Required Written Documentation, page 385), which lists every document the manual requires, and move them to whichever area it names.

What goes in this tab	Type	Present?	Date on it
TECH-01 Technology and System Planning	Policy		
TECH-02 Information Security and Confidentiality of Data	Policy		
TECH-03 Social Media, Mobile Devices, and Electronic Communication	Policy		
2I-01 Information and Communication Technology in Service Delivery (Telehealth)	Policy		
Technology and System Plan	Plan		
System Downtime Service Log and Procedure	Completed form / evidence		
Device and System Access Log	Completed form / evidence		

Surveyor will ask: (1) What happens to service delivery if your EHR is down for two days? (2) When did you last test a restore from backup? (3) Show me your texting and social media rules for peer staff.